MANYCHAT

Leading with context: AI for the human side of engineering leadership

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People Growth Partner, Manychat

My journey at Manychat

01

Frontend Engineer

02

Team Lead

03

People Growth Partner

AI for the human side of engineering leadership

What is engineering management really about?

Make sure the team is working on the right things

and create conditions for them to do it effectively

What are those conditions?

What are those conditions?

Clear direction

goals, priorities, expectations

Trust & safety

feedback, taking risks, healthy conflict

Flow & focus

interruptions, cognitive load

Collaboration

dependability, knowledge sharing

Impact

work creates change

Meaning

work is personally important

Sources: Google Project Aristotle, DORA, SPACE framework

And that's a lot

A lot of people with different perspectives

A lot of projects

A lot of meetings

A lot of scattered signals

You need to continuously
make sense of what's happening
and decide what to do about it.

What about AI?

Two types of tasks

Input → Output

You know what you need.
AI gets it done.



Two types of tasks

Input → Output

You know what you need.
AI gets it done.

Thinking partner

You're still figuring it out.
AI helps you think.



AI helps remove friction

The goal isn't to remove all friction.
It's to remove the right friction.

Example: performance review

- Remember what the person did in the last 6 months
- Compare the facts and analyze their contribution
- Make the decision on the person's rating
- Discuss the results and give feedback

What should AI take over?

Delegate

- transcribe
- format and organize notes
- retrieve information
- extract action items
- track open commitments

Keep human

- set priorities
- apply judgement
- make decisions and own outcomes
- build trust and relationships
- take action

What should AI take over?

Delegate

- transcribe
- format and organize notes
- retrieve information
- extract action items
- track open commitments

Think with AI

- synthesize context
- spot patterns
- challenge assumptions
- evaluate approaches
- reflect on your leadership
- prepare for conversations

Keep human

- set priorities
- apply judgement
- make decisions and own outcomes
- build trust and relationships
- take action

AI can free up your time for the work that actually needs you

Second Brain

Second Brain =

Structured, accessible

context

+

Useful workflows

AI is good at working with context

But more context ≠ better context

Different situations need different context

Joining a new team

- People
- Relationships
- History

Different situations need different context

Joining a new team

- People
- Relationships
- History

Leading through change

- What's changing
- What people know
- Where uncertainty remains

My Second Brain

It all started with ChatGPT







What's inside

CLAUDE.MD

Always use assistant-agent.md.

Files, templates, workflows: ...

assistant-agent.md

about-me.md
- raw-transcripts
- 1-1-processed
- meetings-processed
- people-profiles
- task-tracker
- templates
  - profile-template.md
  - post-meeting-template.md
  - post-1-1-template.md
  - task-template.md

assistant-agent.md

Your role: you are my people-management copilot for an engineering team. Help me reduce cognitive load and become a stronger leader.

Team context: devs, stakeholders, priorities, ways of working, challenges: ...

Your responsibilities:
- Help me prepare for and process 1:1s
- Track commitments, tensions and recurring patterns
- Help me navigate difficult situations
- Challenge my leadership blind spots

How to think:
- Separate individual issues from systemic problems
- Look for patterns, but don't invent motivations
- Turn insights into actions, not endless analysis

How to work with me: - Be direct. Challenge my assumptions. - Point out when I'm taking on too much ownership - Ask when context is missing. Don't make things up.

What's inside

CLAUDE.MD

Always use assistant-agent.md.

Meeting transcripts live in /transcripts, meeting recaps in /post-meetings, people profiles in /profiles, tasks in /task-tracker.

```
assistant-agent.md
about-me.md
raw-transcripts
1-1-processed
meetings-processed
people-profiles
task-tracker
templates
  profile-template.md
  post-meeting-template.md
  post-1-1-template.md
  task-template.md
```

post-1-1-template.md

General: person, date

Key topics discussed: ...

Important quotes or signals: ...

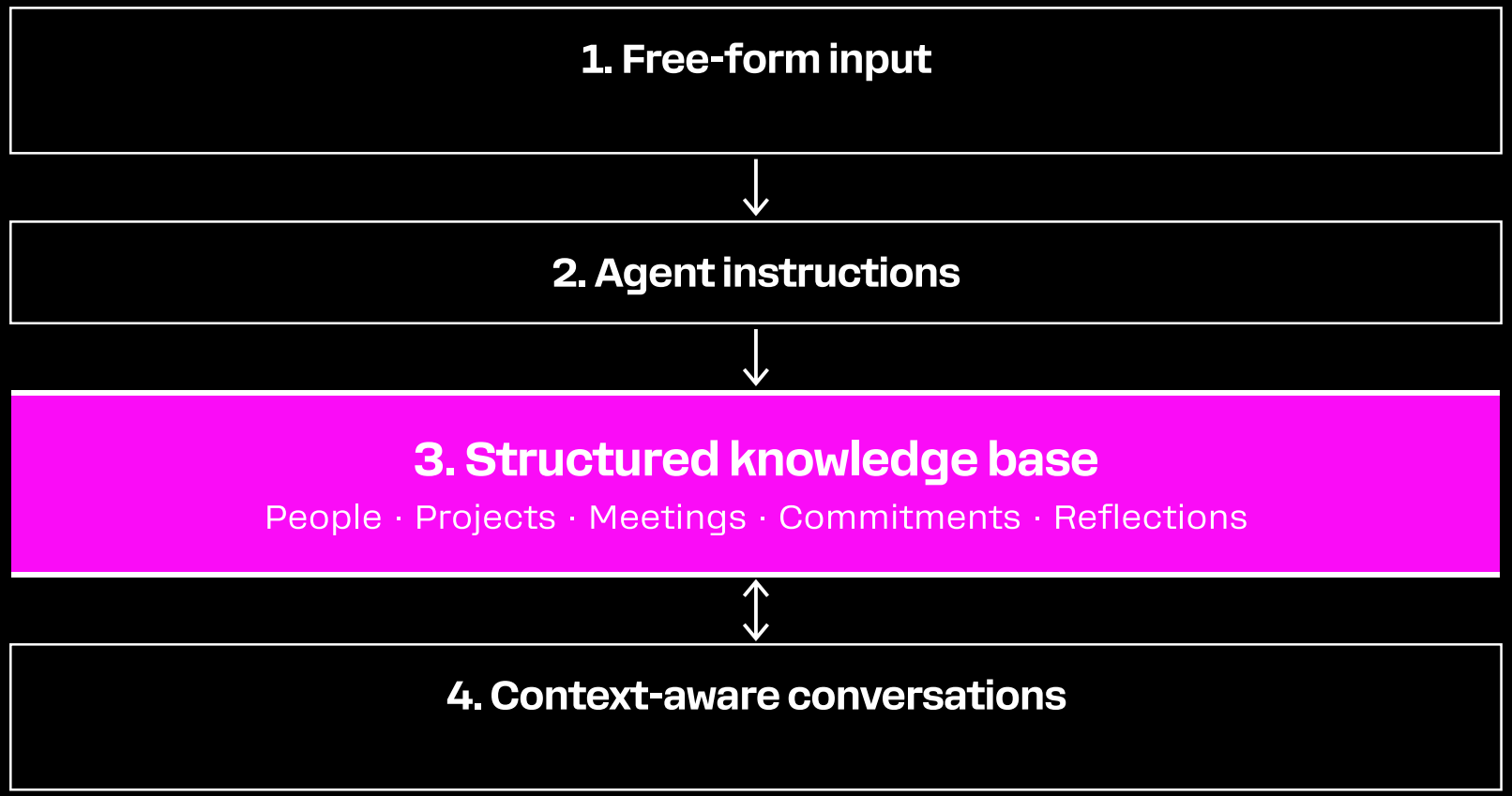
Commitments: ...

Action items from last time:
Resolved: ...
Discussed, still open: ...
Not discussed, still open: ...

Feedback shared:
About them: ...
About me: ...

Person:
energy level: ...
growth edge: ...
goals update: ...

How my system works



GUARDRAILS

Don't assume, ask

Reference sources

It's a garden, not a one-time setup

- Prune outdated or irrelevant context
- Grow new workflows as your needs evolve
- Correct mistakes and recalibrate AI's understanding

So what?

From memory to evidence

From isolated signals to patterns

From information overload to understanding

Your turn

Build a system that supports how you think

STEP 1

Start with a scenario

What recurring task do I want help with?

Start with what your team needs most

Clear direction
goals, priorities, expectations

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feedback, taking risks, healthy conflict

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Build a system that supports how you think

STEP 1

Start with a scenario

What recurring task do I want help with?

STEP 2

Identify useful context

What information does that task require?

Build a system that supports how you think

STEP 1

Start with a scenario

What recurring task do I want help with?

STEP 2

Identify useful context

What information does that task require?

STEP 3

Use it in practice

Where does it help? What's missing?

Build a system that supports how you think

STEP 1

Start with a scenario

What recurring task do I want help with?

STEP 2

Identify useful context

What information does that task require?

STEP 3

Use it in practice

Where does it help? What's missing?

STEP 4

Review and adjust

Update rules, context and structure.

↻ Repeat as your needs evolve

Thank you!



My LinkedIn

Useful links if you want to go deeper

- Google Project Aristotle
- SPACE framework for team effectiveness beyond code output
- DORA reports
- Amy Edmondson's work on psychological safety
  Also recommended, her TED talks: link 1 · link 2
- Richard Hackman's research on enabling conditions